and ten years in some others – with the maximum sentence being life imprisonment. Parliament also attempted to address the identification and revictimization of rape victims following the offence. It was now a criminal offence to disclose the identity of the rape victim without her consent. There were some discernible omissions from the debates leading up to the legislative reform and the amendments themselves – the conversation focused on rape in custodial situations, ignoring the equally important issue of rape within the four walls of the home.

All the while, even as the rape of an Adivasi child galvanized the women's movement and produced legislative reforms, Mathura herself remained on the sidelines. She is reported to have moved to a different village, remarried and started a family. All those years ago, Mathura did what most other women of her time would not have had the resolve to do for fear of a social backlash, police apathy, judicial delays and a host of other reasons. She filed a rape complaint and followed it through to its logical conclusion. The Supreme Court – famously described at the time as the 'last resort for the oppressed and bewildered'[27] – failed her.